

IP Quadrant

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Patent · copyright · trademark · trade secret

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The IP Quadrant organises the four main forms of intellectual property — patent, copyright, trademark and trade secret — clarifying what each protects and how each applies to AI assets.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A foundational construct of intellectual-property law and management, taught across IP-strategy texts.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to help managers match each asset to the appropriate protection rather than defaulting to one form.

FIGURE 1 · IP QUADRANT



Figure 1. A schematic of the IP Quadrant as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Each AI-related asset is classified into the quadrant best suited to it, and a layered protection strategy is built across forms.

WHEN IT IS USED

When designing IP protection for AI products, data and models.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Legal, IP and product-strategy teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It clarifies that AI assets often need a combination of protections, since no single form covers models, data and brand together.

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SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

WIPO (2020) WIPO Technology Trends 2019: Artificial Intelligence. Geneva: WIPO.

Cornish, W., Llewelyn, D. and Aplin, T. (2019) Intellectual Property. London: Sweet & Maxwell.